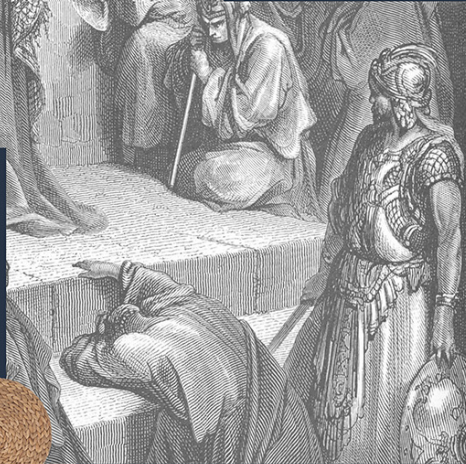
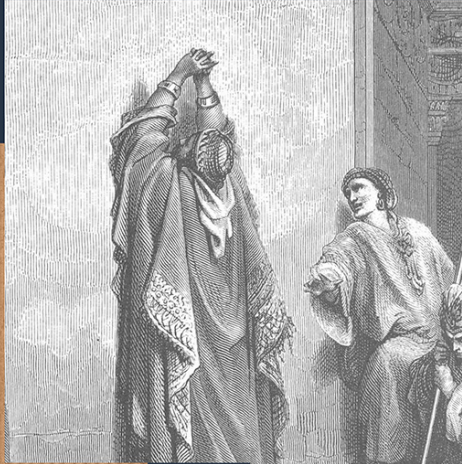


ACTS 2 DEVOTIONS

2 SAMUEL



July - August '26

Hymn of the Month

JULY

Something for Thee

Savior, Thy dying love
Thou gavest me,
Nor should I aught withhold,
Dear Lord, from Thee;
In love my soul would bow,
My heart fulfill its vow,
Some offering bring Thee now,
Something for Thee.

At the blest mercy seat,
Pleading for me,
My feeble faith looks up,
Jesus, to Thee;
Help me the cross to bear,
Thy wondrous love declare,
Some song to raise, or pray'r,
Something for Thee.

Give me a faithful heart,
Likeness to Thee,
That each departing day
Henceforth may see
Some work of love begun,
Some deed of kindness done,
Some wand'rer sought and won,
Something for Thee.

All that I am and have,
Thy gifts so free,
In joy, in grief, through life,
Dear Lord, for Thee!
And when Thy face I see,
My ransom'd soul shall be,
Through all eternity,
Something for Thee.

*Author: S. Dryden Phelps
Composer: Robert Lowry*

AUGUST

And Can It Be?

And can it be that I should gain
An int'rest in the Savior's blood?
Died He for me, who caused His pain?
For me, who Him to death pursued?
Amazing love! how can it be
That Thou, my God, should die for me?

*Amazing love! How can it be
That Thou, my God, should die for me!*

He left His Father's throne above,
So free, so infinite His grace;
Emptied Himself of all but love,
And bled for Adam's helpless race.
'Tis mercy all, immense and free;
O praise my God, it reaches me.

Long my imprisoned spirit lay
Fast bound in sin and nature's night;
Thine eye diffused a quick'ning ray,
I woke, the dungeon flamed with light;
My chains fell off, my heart was free;
I rose, went forth and followed Thee.

No condemnation now I dread;
Jesus and all in Him is mine!
Alive in Him, my living Head,
And clothed in righteousness divine;
Bold I approach th' eternal throne
And claim the crown,
Through Christ, my own.

*Author: Charles Wesley
Composer: Thomas Campbell*

Scripture Memory

On Fridays we will spend time memorizing the chapter or passage of the month.

July	Psalm 1
August	Psalm 8
September	Psalm 16
October	Psalm 23
November	Psalm 32
December	Isaiah 9:1-7
January	Psalm 37:1-9

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 1 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

*"On two occasions ... David had refused to strike him out of respect for Saul as the Lord's anointed one (1 Samuel 24 and 26). Now Saul has been struck down by an Amalekite – a people with a long history of animosity toward Israel and a nemesis to both Saul and David. David cannot allow the inviolability of God's anointed to be broken. He cannot allow the precedent of letting violence to God's anointed go unpunished. He cannot allow his own loyalty to Saul as God's anointed one to be questioned."*¹

2 Samuel 1:1-16

- What is surprising about David's response to the Amalekite? Contrast the Amalekite's worldview to David's.
- Reflect on David's heart of genuine loyalty and love even for Saul. How did David keep his heart from bitterness and hatred towards Saul?

Monday, July 13, 2026

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dotted lines.

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 2 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 2:1-9

- Contrast David and Abner's actions after Saul's death. What is the fundamental difference in their views towards power? How am I challenged regarding my view towards power? Reflect on David's response to the men of Jabesh Gilead. What does this reveal about David?

2 Samuel 2:12-31

- Reflect on the consequences and lessons from Abner and Joab. What are the warnings for me about operating according to tribal loyalties? How responsive am I to words of caution when I am pursuing a certain path, perhaps over-aggressively or with a failure to see some larger picture?

Tuesday, July 14, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 3 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

- Do a character study of each of the characters in this chapter:
 - Ish-bosheth
 - Abner
 - David
 - Joab
- What are they like and what lessons can you learn from them about fear, leadership, personal grudges, and wisdom?

Wednesday, July 15, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 4 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

- Do a character study of the following people in this chapter and reflect on the lessons you can learn from them:
 - Ish-bosheth
 - Baanah and Rechab
 - David

Thursday, July 16, 2026

-10- JULY & AUGUST 2026 • ACTS2 NETWORK DEVOTIONALS

Scripture Memory: Psalm 1

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, July 17, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 5 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 5:1-12

- Reflect on God's faithfulness to David throughout the years leading up to becoming king.
- How has the LORD been faithful to me through all the ups and downs of my life? How have I experienced God blessing me "for the sake of his people"?

2 Samuel 5:17-25

- What lessons can I learn from the fact that David was not done with fighting after becoming king? What battles am I challenged to keep fighting in obedience to God?

Monday, July 20, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 6 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 6:6-8

"In a way that seems especially foreign to present-day readers, the unfortunate Uzzah illustrates the holiness of God present in the ark. 'To touch the ark is to impinge on God's holiness, to draw too close and presume too much.' The Israelites have not taken his power and holiness seriously enough, and now David is left with the question (6:9): 'How can the ark of the Lord ever come to me?' The text implies that the ark (and hence God's presence) can and will come into David's life, but his power and holiness come with it. Such warnings are healthy, indeed needed, in order to protect God's people from tendencies to trivialize God's holiness."²

- What was offensive about Uzzah's act of taking "hold of the ark of God"?
- How does this incident challenge my understanding of God's holiness?

2 Samuel 6:14-22

"Note that Michal is identified in her first appearance in this unit as the 'daughter of Saul' rather than the 'wife of David.' In her objections and demeanor, she manifests her father's disposition rather than her husband's. While nation and king celebrate the joyous occasion, Michal sulks as though Saul would have done better."³

- What lessons and warnings can I learn from Michal?

² Bill T. Arnold, *NIV Application Commentary: 1 & 2 Samuel* (Zondervan, 2003), 458.

3 Bill T. Arnold, *NIV Application Commentary: 1 & 2 Samuel* (Zondervan, 2003), 476.

Tuesday, July 21, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 7 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 7:1-13

"Startlingly, God reverses David's proposal. David cannot build a house for the Lord; the Lord will build a house for David. Using the potential for multiple meanings in the word bayit ("house"), God rejects 'temple' but promises 'dynasty.' The grace shown to David in the past will now extend into the future. This promise is not simply for David, but for the line of David that will come after him."⁴

- What is the picture of God that emerges in this passage? How have I experienced this kind of covenantal and personal God in my life?

2 Samuel 7:14-24

*"The oracle of Nathan in 2 Sam 7:4-16 locates God's grace toward Israel in an unconditional and everlasting promise to the line of David. This was a new theological understanding in Israel and stood in tension with the conditional 'if' of the Mosaic covenant at Mt. Sinai. [...] Obedience to covenant requirements is still demanded. Judgment, even of Davidic kings, is still the consequence of covenant disobedience (7:14b), but the commitment of God to steadfast love toward David's line and the Davidic kingdom is everlasting and cannot be broken (7:15-16)."*⁵

- How do David's sentiments resonate with or challenge me?

⁴ Thomas B. Dozeman, *The New Interpreter's Bible*, volume 2 (Abingdon Press, 1998), 1257.

5 Thomas B. Dozeman, *The New Interpreter's Bible*, volume 2 (Abingdon Press, 1998), 1255.

Wednesday, July 22, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 8 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

"This chapter illustrates that God is faithful to his Word and strengthens his servants for the task to which he has called them. So what can it mean for today's believers to have victory wherever we go? It means that God has already won the victory and has promised to strengthen us for the tasks we are called to perform in the church and in the world. As David defeated Israel's enemies, so today's believers can expect to accomplish successfully our God-given and God-ordained tasks, with the help of the Holy Spirit. This catalogue of military victories should inspire confidence in all believers that God is at work fulfilling his Word through his people."⁶

- What is inspiring about David's response to the increasing victories and blessings in his life?
- How is the statement "The Lord gave victory to David wherever he went" also true of my life?
- How am I challenged to administer "justice and equity" in the tasks God has entrusted me with?

⁶ Bill T. Arnold, *NIV Application Commentary: 1 & 2 Samuel* (Zondervan, 2003), 502.

Thursday, July 23, 2026

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 sets of three horizontal dotted lines.

Scripture Memory: Psalm 1

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, July 24, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 9 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 9:1

- What can I learn from David searching for anyone “left of the house of Saul that [he] may show him kindness for Jonathan’s sake”?

2 Samuel 9:2-8

- How must Mephibosheth have felt when summoned by the king? How must Mephibosheth have felt when he heard David say, “Do not fear, for I will show you kindness... I will restore to you all...and you shall eat at my table always”?

2 Samuel 9:11-13

- Reflect on this picture of Mephibosheth, crippled in both feet, eating “at David’s table, like one of the king’s sons.” In what ways have I been the recipient of this kind of undeserved grace from God?

Monday, July 27, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 10 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 10:1-4, 13-18

- Have there been times when I have interpreted people’s expressions of kindness as something sinister? In what ways have my suspicions and fears caused me to miss opportunities to connect with the people God has placed in my life?
- What are some ways in which people of this world respond like Hanun to those who try to share the message of God’s love?

2 Samuel 10:6

- What can I learn about human nature from the fact that the Ammonites prepared for war when they “saw that they had become a stench to David”?
- What could the Ammonites have done differently at this point?
- Are there times when I, upon realizing I had sinned against someone, have responded like the Ammonites?

2 Samuel 10:11-12

- How is vv. 11-12 a beautiful picture of how we are to function in the body of Christ?
- Reflect on Joab’s statement in v. 12. What is the relationship between Joab’s pledge to “be courageous for our people, and for the cities of our God” and his confidence that “the Lord [will] do what seems good to him”?

Tuesday, July 28, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 11 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

*"David sends his commander Joab and his army to continue the battle against Ammon. The result is the mass slaughter of the Ammonites and the siege of Rabbah, their capital city, the reduction and capture of which is yet to come (cf. 12:26-29). Every able-bodied man in Israel goes to war—except the king himself. The contrast between David and his men could hardly be expressed in starker terms. Staying home in such situations was not his usual practice, of course (cf. 5:2; 8:1-14; 10:17). Indeed, leading one's troops into battle was expected to be the major external activity of an ancient Near Eastern ruler (see 1Sa 8:5-6, 20)."*⁷

2 Samuel 11:1-5

- Reflect on the words, “But David remained at Jerusalem.” What warning does this have for me regarding temptations?
- Reflect on the steps David took that led to his terrible sin. At what point could he have turned around? What are some personal lessons for me from David’s sin?

2 Samuel 11:8-11

- What kind of man was Uriah?
- What is the difference in thought and values between Uriah and David at this point?
- To what extent do I view my life within the context of camaraderie and faithfulness to a larger group of which I am a part?

2 Samuel 11:27

- Reflect on the significance of the words, “But the thing that David had done displeased the LORD.”
- Who is the ultimate judge over my life? Are there sins that I am hiding and refusing to deal with?

7 Kenneth L. Barker and John R. Kohlenberger III, *NIV Bible Commentary* (Zondervan, 1994).

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 12:1-15a (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 12:1-7

- Note the irony of David's response: "David's anger was greatly kindled against the man" in Nathan's story and his response was, "the man who has done this deserves to die."
- How would David have felt upon hearing the words, "You are the man"?
- When was the last time I had this kind of painful confrontation with the truth about my sins?

2 Samuel 12:7-9

- Reflect on the fact that to “do what is evil” is equivalent to “despis[ing] the word of the Lord” and the Lord himself (vv. 9-10). To what extent do I grasp that when I sin, I am sinning against God?
- How did David come to this point in his life where he despised God’s word and even committed adultery and murder? How can I guard myself against going down such a tragic path?

Thursday, July 30, 2026

-30- JULY & AUGUST 2026 • ACTS2 NETWORK DEVOTIONALS

Scripture Memory: Psalm 1

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, July 31, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 12:15b-31 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 12:10-18

- Why does God bring punishment to David although he had forgiven him?

2 Samuel 12:13, 19-31

- What is the picture of genuine repentance from the way David responds both to Nathan’s rebuke and the death of his child, and then finally leads his people in battle once again?
- Reflect on God’s response to Solomon, and the fact that Nathan brings a special name from God to David and Bathsheba. What does this show about God’s willingness to completely restore his relationship with those who repent?

Monday, August 3, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 13 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 13:1-17

- What is the significance of Jonadab's conversation with Amnon? What did his shrewd advice result in, specifically for Tamar?
- In what ways do I fail to recognize the victims involved when I'm pursuing my illicit desires?
- How do I typically handle my wrong desires?
- Note David's role in this entire story.

"We have known David as a man of decisive action, but in this and subsequent episodes narrating the drama of his own family, David is curiously passive and indecisive. Perhaps David is himself so morally compromised by his own flagrant crimes that he cannot confront the excesses of his sons. David may be angry, but he joins the conspiracy of silence around the rape of Tamar, and in doing so he unwittingly allows Absalom's murderous revenge to run its course."⁸

2 Samuel 13:21-34

- What was notably missing after the statement that King David “was very angry” about this incident (v. 21)?
- What may have been behind David’s refusal to render proper judgment on Amnon? What tragic consequences did this lead to?
- What lesson does this have for me?

8 Bruce C. Birch, "The First and Second Books of Samuel," *The New Interpreter's Bible*, volume 2 (Abingdon Press, 1998), 1305.

Tuesday, August 4, 2026

-36- JULY & AUGUST 2026 • ACTS2 NETWORK DEVOTIONALS

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 14 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 14:1-21

- David's failure to take action against Amnon's sin precipitated Absalom's revenge. Again, King David is depicted as passive while others around him take action. Consider the dilemma David is facing as father and king. How did he come to be in this situation?
- Note that compared to what he should have done with Amnon, the current situation with Absalom is less clear. What can we learn from this?

2 Samuel 14:13-14

"The woman of Tekoa meant, 'Find a way to do it, David. God finds a way to bring us back to Himself.' It is true that God finds a way - but not at the expense of justice. God reconciles us by satisfying justice, not by ignoring justice...God has devised a way to bring the banished back to Him, that they might not be expelled from Him. The way is through the person and work of Jesus, and how He stood in the place of guilty sinners as He hung on the cross and received the punishment that we deserved."⁹

- Reflect once again on the different demands of love and justice, and the picture of David, whose “heart went out to Absalom” (v.1) but who could not get himself to freely embrace him. How has God resolved this dilemma in my favor?
- Reflect on the fact that God “devises means so that the banished one will not remain an outcast” (v. 14).

2 Samuel 14:32-33

- Absalom seems to be offended by David treating him as an exile. What aspect of human nature is displayed in Absalom's sense of injury?
- To what extent have I seen this kind of tendency in my life?

⁹ David Guzik, "2 Samuel Chapter 14," The Enduring Word Bible Commentary, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/2-samuel-14/>.

Wednesday, August 5, 2026

-38- JULY & AUGUST 2026 • ACTS2 NETWORK DEVOTIONALS

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 15 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 15:1-6

- What is wrong with Absalom endorsing people's grievances?
- What about human nature can I learn from Absalom's success in gaining the hearts of the men of Israel?

2 Samuel 15:1-12

*"Absalom is no sooner restored to his place at court than he aims to be on the throne. He that was unhumbled under his troubles became insufferably proud when they were over; and he cannot be content with the honour of being the king's son, and the prospect of being his successor, but he must be king now."*¹⁰

- Reflect on Absalom's unrepentant attitude in the previous chapter. Are there ways in which I have responded to grace with increased arrogance?

"In their conquest of the land, the Israelites defeated Og, king of Bashan, and Jair of Manasseh took Bashan as far as the border of the Geshurites and Maacathites (Dt 3:14). Though the land of the Geshurites was given to the Transjordanian tribes (Jos 13:11), Israel did not drive them out (v 13). Later, Geshur and Aram took at least 60 towns from the Israelites in Transjordan (1 Chr 2:23).

*"David married Maacah, daughter of Talmai, king of Geshur, and she bore Absalom (2 Sm 3:3; 1 Chr 3:2). After the vengeful murder of Amnon, Absalom fled to Geshur for refuge with his grandfather, Talmai (2 Sm 13:37) and stayed there three years."*¹¹

- Absalom's conspiratorial murder of Amnon; his subsequent flight to Geshur to stay three years with his maternal grandfather, the king of Geshur (a nation which has been at war with Israel); the odd manner of his return and his subsequent internal exile; and David's eventual acceptance of him, all somehow contributed to this final act of open rebellion. Reflect on the ways in which David failed Absalom as a father and king, and the points of intervention that David missed. What are some ways I harbor a similar passivity and fail to take painful corrective steps with someone who has gone wayward?

2 Samuel 15:13-14

- What can I learn from David's response in these verses?

2 Samuel 15:18-22

- The Gittites are natives of the Philistine city of Gath. They must have served under David when he was with Achish, the Philistine king at Gath, and chosen to follow David (1 Samuel 27:1-4). What can I learn from Ittai's response to David?

2 Samuel 15:25-26

- What kind of understanding of God and of himself does David demonstrate in his response to Zadok?

¹⁰ Matthew Henry, "Matthew Henry Bible Commentary (complete)," Christianity.com, [¹¹ Matthew Henry, "Matthew Henry Bible Commentary \(complete\)," Christianity.com, \[2 SAMUEL -39-\]\(https://www.christianity.com/bible/commentary/matthew-henry-complete/2-samuel/15; W. A. Elwell & P. W. Comfort, Tyndale Bible Dictionary \(Tyndale House Publishers, 2001\), 527.</p></div><div data-bbox=\)](https://www.christianity.com/bible/commentary/matthew-henry-complete/2-samuel/15; W. A. Elwell & P. W. Comfort, Tyndale Bible Dictionary (Tyndale House Publishers, 2001), 527.</p></div><div data-bbox=)

Thursday, August 6, 2026

2 Samuel 15:13-30

"David and his people proceed on their way over to the Mount of Olives (v.30). David weeps; his head is covered; he walks on bare feet. This is not the portrait of a political or military retreat. It is a penitential procession. David has cast his fate in the hands of God, and he moves forward in penance and in supplication for God's mercy. His people join him in these acts of ritual penance."¹²

- Reflect on the picture of David leaving Jerusalem “weeping as he went, barefoot and with his head covered.”

12 Bruce C. Birch, "The First and Second Books of Samuel," *The New Interpreter's Bible*, volume 2 (Abingdon Press, 1998), 1325.

Thursday, August 6, 2026

Friday, August 7, 2026

Scripture Memory: Psalm 8

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, August 7, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 16 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 16:1-4

“David knew Mephibosheth not to be an ambitious man ... yet David gives credit to the calumny, and, without further enquiry or consideration, convicts Mephibosheth of treason, seizes his lands as forfeited, and grants them to Ziba: ... which afterwards he was ashamed of, when the truth came to light...”¹³

- David’s judgment seems to have been clouded by Ziba’s generosity towards David and his men. He believed Ziba’s story of Mephibosheth’s disloyalty without investigating the truth. What lesson is here for me regarding my sense of objectivity and whether I seek actual facts about people who are generous or kind toward me?
- Reflect on Ziba’s wicked conduct. Is there something about his disloyalty, deceit, and opportunism that I need to guard against?

2 Samuel 16:5-13

“No man could be more innocent of the blood of the house of Saul than David was. Once and again he spared Saul’s life, while Saul sought his. When Saul and his sons were slain by the Philistines, David and his men were many miles off; and, when they heard it, they lamented it. ... Innocency is no fence against malice and falsehood; nor are we to think it strange if we be charged with that from which we have been most careful to keep ourselves. It is well for us that men are not to be our judges, but he whose judgment is according to truth ... See how forward malicious men are to press God’s judgments into the service of their own passion and revenge.”¹⁴

- What sort of person is Shimei? What is his view of how God works? Have I ever attributed someone’s misfortunes to God’s judgment based on my own preferred interpretation on the matter?
- Reflect on David’s response to Shimei.

2 Samuel 16:15-23

- What does Ahithophel’s shocking advice reveal about his worldview?
- What impact would the immorality Absalom committed “in the sight of all Israel” have had on the life and culture of the nation?
- Reflect on the destructive power of wrong advice. As I share my opinions and advice with others, how careful am I to provide good, godly advice?
- Is there someone (or some source of supposed wisdom) like Ahithophel in my life that I am listening to?

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¹³ Matthew Henry, "Matthew Henry Bible Commentary (complete)," Christianity.com, <https://www.christianity.com/bible/commentary/matthew-henry-complete/2-samuel/16>.
¹⁴ Matthew Henry, "Matthew Henry Bible Commentary (complete)," Christianity.com, <https://www.christianity.com/bible/commentary/matthew-henry-complete/2-samuel/16>.

Monday, August 10, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 17 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 17:1-14

"Hushai's successful effort to counter the advice of Ahithophel is a classic use of the principles of rhetoric being used to convince a person to take a certain action. He appealed to fear, to the desire for military glory, and to Absalom's strong desire for personal achievement."¹⁵

- What can I learn about Absalom's character from the fact that he was persuaded by Hushai's advice over that of Ahithophel's?
- How prone am I to listen to the advice of others simply because it appeals to my fears or my ego?
- What can I learn from v. 14 and the fact that these events were an answer to David's prayer in 2 Samuel 15:31?

2 Samuel 17:23

- What kind of person is Ahithophel?

2 Samuel 17:15-22, 27-29

- Who are the people God placed in David's life who risked their lives to protect him?
- Who are the people God placed in David's life to provide for him during this desperate time?
- Spend some time listing all the people God has used to protect and provide for you, and spend time thanking God for them.

15 Kenneth Chafin, *Mastering the Old Testament: 1 & 2 Samuel* (Word Publishing, 1989), 343.

Tuesday, August 11, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 18:1-18 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 18:5, 10-17

- What kind of man is Joab?
- Reflect on Absalom's tragic end.
- Recall Absalom's description from 2 Samuel 14:25-26:

2 Samuel 14:25–26 (ESV)

²⁵ Now in all Israel there was no one so much to be praised for his handsome appearance as Absalom. From the sole of his foot to the crown of his head there was no blemish in him. ²⁶ And when he cut the hair of his head (for at the end of every year he used to cut it; when it was heavy on him, he cut it), he weighed the hair of his head, two hundred shekels by the king's weight.

- During the battle Absalom gets caught in an oak tree, most likely by his hair; is unseated from his mule (the mount of choice for royalty); and dangles in midair before he is killed. The chapter ends with a great heap of stones piled on his corpse, and the notation that he had set up a pillar in his own name. What are some lessons from Absalom's life?

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 18:19-33 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 18:33

As author Frederick Buechner wrote of the ending scene of this chapter: *"[David] meant it, of course. If he could have done the boy's dying for him, he would have done it. If he could have paid the price for the boy's betrayal of him, he would have paid it. If he could have given his own life to make the boy alive again, he would have given it. But even a king can't do things like that. ... it takes God."*¹⁶

- Reflect on the depth of David's love for his son, and the limitation of human love at its best.
- What sort of dilemma did David's love for Absalom create for his men?
- What are some aspects of the cross this story depicts?

16 Frederick Buechner, *Peculiar Treasures* (HarperOne, 1993), 6.

Handwriting practice lines consisting of 20 horizontal dotted lines.

Scripture Memory: Psalm 8

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, August 14, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 19:1-15 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 19:1-4

- What makes David's mourning inappropriate, even if it was understandable?
- When it comes to my emotions or moods, how other-centered am I?

2 Samuel 19:5-8

- What is amazing about David's response to Joab? How might he have responded differently?
- Do I have this kind of responsiveness towards truth, regardless of how or when it is delivered?

Monday, August 17, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 19:16-43 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 19:16-23

- Reflect on the source of David's magnanimity toward Shimei. How does my identity in Christ give me generosity of spirit toward those who have hurt me?

2 Samuel 19:16-30

- The incident of Mephibosheth and Ziba once again shows the need to 'hear both sides of the story' in order to be just, and to accurately assess situations involving different parties. Am I prone to being swayed by the first story I hear? To what extent am I disciplined in withholding judgment until all sides and the objective facts have been considered?

Tuesday, August 18, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 20 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 20:1-2

"Although Israel was a united kingdom, it was still made up of 12 separate tribes. These tribes often had difficulty agreeing on the goals of the nation as a whole ... and now tribal jealousies were threatening the stability of David's reign by giving Sheba an opportunity to rebel."¹⁷

- What can I learn about the men of Israel deserting David to follow Sheba, who just “happened to be there”?
- Are there ways in which I allow tribal loyalties to prevent me from submitting to God-ordained authority in my life?

2 Samuel 20:4-22

*"Joab represents perhaps the most complex example [of power]. He appears loyal to David, though the reader is forced to wonder if Joab is motivated simply by his need to preserve his access to power. At times he appears unconcerned about divine mandate or royal decree while he uses his military might ruthlessly."*¹⁸

- What kind of portrait emerges of Joab?
- Are there ways in which I appear loyal to God or to certain people while being motivated by my personal desire for power?

2 Samuel 20:15-22

- What kind of disaster was averted through the wise woman's intervention?
- Joab built the siege works and began battering the wall because, as a military leader, that's what he knew how to do, and that was his basic mode of accomplishing his objectives. What is my favored or typical modus operandi when faced with a problem or obstacle?

¹⁷ *Life Application Study Bible*, study notes (Zondervan; Tyndale House, 1991), 529.

18 *Life Application Study Bible*, study notes (Zondervan; Tyndale House, 1991), 610-611.

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 21 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 21:1-9

- David “sought the face of the Lord” in the face of three successive years of famine. How do I respond when I am in a situation beyond my control?

"Although the Bible does not record Saul's act of vengeance against the Gibeonites, it was apparently a serious crime making him guilty of their blood. Still, why were Saul's sons killed for the murders their father committed? In many Near Eastern cultures, including Israel's, an entire family was held guilty for the crime of the father because the family was considered an indissoluble unit. Saul broke the vow that the Israelites made to the Gibeonites (Joshua 9:16-20). This was a serious offense against God's law (Numbers 30:1-2). Either David was following the custom of treating the family as a unit, or Saul's sons were guilty of helping Saul kill the Gibeonites."¹⁹

- Reflect on the consequences of Saul's sin.

2 Samuel 21:1-14

- Reflect on the loving actions of David bringing “the bones of Saul and the bones of his son Jonathan” and “the bones of those who were hanged” and giving them a proper burial after such a tragic episode. What lesson is here about the proper course of action in the midst of tragedy?
- What is the significance of the statement: “And after that God responded to the plea for the land”?

2 Samuel 21:15-22

- Reflect on the following words: "There was war again," "After this there was war," and "And there was again war." What does this passage say about the working out of God's promises?
- What are some promises that I, as a child of God, need to lay hold of through courageous obedience?

¹⁹ *Life Application Study Bible* (Tyndale, 1991), 531.

Thursday, August 20, 2026

Scripture Memory: Psalm 8

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, August 21, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 22 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 22:1-7

- Think about the number and intensity of the actual situations that must have given rise to the varied expressions in vv. 5-6. What relationship is there between the wide range of David's difficulties and the extensive range of David's description of what God has been to him?
- How have I forfeited such fellowship with God by avoiding difficulties?

2 Samuel 22:8-20

- Reflect on the following words: “He sent from on high” (v.17), “he drew me out” (v. 17), “He rescued me” (v. 18), “the Lord was my support” (v. 19), and “he delighted in me” (v. 20). How do these words describe what God has done (and is doing) in my life?

2 Samuel 22:32-51

"It is only in section three of this song (vv.29-51) that we come to the combination of royal gifts with the ultimate empowering (and forgiving) grace of God, which makes the future possible for God's people. [...] The king is nothing without the grace of God; nevertheless, God has chosen to work through David and the subsequent kings of his line. God has chosen to work messianically – that is, through God's anointed one. It is this combination of divine providence and human action that uniquely summarizes the books of Samuel and the story of David in particular."²⁰

- David's life is a clear testament of God's triumph over sin. Have I accepted the fact that God gives "great salvation" from sin and death, and my sin is not the final word over my life?

20 Bruce C. Birch, "The First and Second Books of Samuel," *The New Interpreter's Bible*, volume 2 (Abingdon Press, 1998), 1366.

Monday, August 24, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 23:1-12 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 23:8-12

- Reflect on the fact that while “the men of Israel withdrew,” Eleazar “rose and struck down the Philistines until his hand was weary.” Again, “the men fled” but Shammah “took his stand.” What does it take to stand my ground when others flee?
- Notice that after Eleazar and Shammah’s valiant actions are described, the text follows with the words, “the Lord worked a great victory.” What can I learn about how God works and the role I need to play in his kingdom work?

Tuesday, August 25, 2026

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 23:13-39 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 23:14-17

“This story is retold here to give readers insight into the caliber of men with whom David surrounded himself. They treated his wish almost as a command and risked their lives fighting their way through the Philistine garrison in order to bring their leader a drink from the well (v.16). Although their names are not given, they have modeled for succeeding generations a kind of enthusiastic, loving selfforgetfulness in relationship with others. ... this is the kind of thinking that Christ needs from each of His children, that His slightest wish would be considered by us to be a command that we would joyfully do whatever the cost...”²¹

- What are the characteristics of the “mighty men” shown by this exploit? What does this show about their relationship with David, their commander?
- How can I exhibit these same characteristics in my relationship with God?
- What can I learn from David from what he does with the precious gift brought to him by the three men?

2 Samuel 23:8-39

“While the names on the list mean little to today’s readers it should serve as a reminder that every movement, whether it is the building of a nation or a church, is dependent upon a host of loyal, faithful people who give themselves unselfishly. Often history lifts up the names of the leaders and tends to forget the faithful followers. Like the historian, we should preserve the names of God’s mighty men and women.”²²

- Who are the “mighty men” that God has placed in my life, without whom I would not be where I am today in my experience of God’s promises to me?
- What were the backgrounds and humble beginnings of these mighty men who followed David? What hope can this give me?

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²¹ Kenneth Chafin, *Mastering the Old Testament: 1, 2 Samuel* (Word Publishing, 1989), 393.
²² Kenneth Chafin, *Mastering the Old Testament: 1, 2 Samuel* (Word Publishing, 1989), 393.

Bible Text: 2 Samuel 24 (ESV)

Option 1: Questions for Personal Study & Reflection

- What does this passage teach me about God, myself, or human nature?
- How can I apply lessons from this passage to my life?

Option 2: Questions to Help You Go Deeper

2 Samuel 24:1-3

- Why is it that, in this case, taking the census is offensive to God?
- In what ways do I take stock of my accomplishments or possessions when I feel like God may not deliver on his promises?
- What do I draw my security and pride from apart from God?

2 Samuel 24:10

- It is through David's own conscience that he realizes he has sinned against God in taking the census. What is the role of conscience in realizing sin and what should be my response to the witness of my conscience?
- How reliable is my conscience and how responsive am I to its prodding?

2 Samuel 24:24

- David insists on paying for the threshing floor and any burnt offering even though he could have easily gotten them for free. What does this show about true repentance, and about the proper attitude in coming before God in general?

Scripture Memory: Psalm 8

Please feel free to use the space below to review and memorize the passage.

Friday, August 28, 2026

Friday, August 28, 2026

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2 SAMUEL 22:29-31

For you are my lamp, O Lord,
and my God lightens my darkness.
For by you I can run against a troop,
and by my God I can leap over a wall.

This God—his way is perfect;
the word of the Lord proves true;
he is a shield for all those who take refuge in him.